



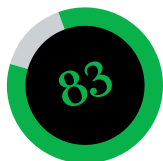
Sigma breaking boundaries

Sigma has announced the 18-35mm f/1.8 APS-C zoom thus breaking the f/2.0 barrier. Expect a price of around \$2000 or more. <http://dgit.in/Y3wLhK>

Inhon Blade 13 Carbon

Weighing at 1.9-pounds and measuring 10.7mm thick, the Taiwanese laptop can be yours for \$1,350. Soon. <http://dgit.in/ZMeReG>

Bazaar



Xolo X1000

A beauty and a beast

Features 80
Performance 80
Build Quality 80
Value for money 90

Specifications

Operating System: Android 4.0 ICS; **Screen size:** 4.7-inch at 1280x720 pixel; **Built-in Storage:** 8GB; **MicroSD card support:** 32GB RAM: 1GB; **Camera in MP:** 8; Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n, Bluetooth 2.1; **Battery:** 1900mAh. **Processor:** 2 GHz Intel Atom with Hyper Threading, **Chipset:** Intel Atom Processor Z2480

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The Xolo X1000 has a unibody design, which means that you don't have access to the battery. The bottom panel does pop out though, giving you access to the SIM card and microSD card slot. The rear of the smartphone has a rubberised finish, which not only adds to the grip but the elegant looks of the device as well.

The front of the device is covered by a glass sheet that, with its curved edges, is very reminiscent of the Nexus 4. The display is vibrant and very good to use. Consuming multimedia content on the display is a treat. The call quality from the X100 too is good.

The Camera on the X1000 is an 8MP shooter. The performance however isn't the best. Noise is very evident even in well-lit scenes and the images don't look that good when blown up.



Price
₹19,999

What is unique about the X1000 is the 2 GHz Atom Z2480 processor which has a hyper-threaded single core. The CPU is quite capable and even graphically intensive games such as *Dead Trigger* run well.

The on-board speaker is quite decent as well and while we expected more from it, it's at least on par with the competition.

It's easy to recommend the Xolo X1000 at ₹20,000 for the features on offer. The only downside of the device is that it runs on Android 4.0 ICS but an update is expected soon. You get a device that is extremely well built, has a display to die for and the curve glass feels sexy in ones hands. To add to that, you have the distinction of using one of the few Intel-based phones available

Sameer Mitha

Bose SoundLink Air

Pristine sound quality but a limited feature set

We quite like Bose's policy of not allowing users to tweak their sound. Some speakers do need tweaking, but the SoundLink Air is one of the few, natural sounding speakers and we would rather not have someone mess with them. The surprise with the SoundLink Air is that it has a lot more bass impact than most speakers of this size, including its siblings. The vocals are very crisp, but retain an amount of softness that is comfortable for the ears. This speaker is equally at ease playing back a variety of music. However, the virtual ceiling is pretty much reached with the volume around 80 per cent, because post that, distortion is very evident in the lower frequencies.

The setup will be a tad confusing for most users, because you first need to download a utility on the desktop, connect the SoundLink Air to it via a bundled cable and get it to access the Wi-Fi hotspot that the Airplay device (iPod Touch, in this

case) is connected to. The optional battery pack is a good add-on, but that will cost more money.

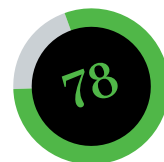
The SoundLink is well-built and the minimalism is sprinkled well with certain thoughtful elements such as the wall adapter having a groove for the cable. Above the speaker grille are

the LEDs for Air Play connectivity, volume mute and AUX connectivity. The remote is fairly simple – you surely cannot get lost in this one.

Visbal Mathur



Price
₹22,384



Features 70
Performance 75
Build Quality 85
Value for money 80

Specifications

Type: Portable music system; **Connectivity:** AirPlay and AUX-in; **Battery:** Optional; **Weight:** 2.1 kg

Contact

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